

Scoreboard

External USB TV Tuners

BRAND	Compro	Compro	Compro	Hauppauge	Hauppauge
MODEL	VideoMate U890	VideoMate U900	VideoMate Action Pro	WinTV-USB	WinTV-USB-FM
Features (Out of 45)	27.40	28.93	32.64	16.79	21.83
Type (Internal/External)	External	External	External	External	External
FM Radio (✓/✗)	✗	✗	✓	✗	✓
Hardware Encoder (✓/✗)	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗
TV Standards (NTSC / PAL)	Both	Both	Both	Both	Both
Video I/O ports					
Co-axial	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
S-Video	✗	✗	✓	✓	✓
Composite	✗	✗	✓	✗	✗
Remote Control					
Remote Control (✓/✗)	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗
Number of Buttons on Remote	32	32	44	NA	NA
Recording/Timeshift Using Remote	Both	Both	Both	NA	NA
Other Features	Media Player Control	Media Player Control	Media Player Control	NA	NA
Connecting Cables (List)	USB Data	USB Data (short and long), USB Power, Stereo to RCA-In, Video to Composite-In	USB Data, USB Power, Audio, FM Aerial, S-Video+Audio cable	Audio	Audio, FM Aerial
Other Accessories	Coaxial Converter	Coaxial Converter	None	Comp to S-Video Conv.	Comp to S-Video Conv.
Software Bundle (List)	ComproDTV 3, ComproDVD 2, Ulead's PhotoExplorer 8.5 SE, DVD MovieFactory 4 SE	ComproPVR 2, ComproDVD 2, Ulead's PhotoExplorer 8.5 SE, VideoStudio 8 SE DVD, DVD MovieFactory 3 SE	ComproPVR 3, ComproFM 2, ComproDVD 2, Ulead PhotoExplorer 8.5 SE	SoftPVR	SoftPVR
PVR Features (✓/✗)					
Timeshift	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Scheduling	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
MPEG1	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
MPEG2	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
MPEG4	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
WinXP Media Centre Edition Compatible (✓/✗)	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗
Windows Vista Ready (✓/✗)	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗
Performance (Out of 48)	34.69	34.69	37.39	36.59	36.59
Ease of Installation/Use (So10)					
Driver	9	9	9	9	9
PVR	9	9	9	9	9
Number of TV Channels Detected (Max. 90*)	82	82	86	84	84
Fine Tuning Necessary? (✓/✗)	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Visual Quality (So10)	7.5	7.5	9	9	9
Price (Rs.)	3,195	3,395	3,295	5,200	7,150
Price Index (Out of 7)	3.15	2.96	3.05	1.93	1.41
Final Score (Out of 100)	65.24	66.58	73.07	55.83	60.35

* This is the total number of available cable channels during the test



+ Good software bundle
- No AV-In port



+ Good software bundle, Sleek
- None in particular



+ Excellent video quality
- None in particular



+ Excellent video quality
- Expensive



+ FM radio
- Very expensive

TV-812Plus also has all the required cables. Compro also bundles coaxial converters with the U890 and the U900, though it is not needed with the U900, which has a coaxial port compatible with Indian standards.

Software Bundle And PVR

PVR software is standard with all the TV-Tuners, and they are more or less similar in features. Some, such as the WinFast PVR that accompanies the Leadtek Winfast, feature PIP (Picture-In-

Picture), but with a major difference: it is capable of displaying two channels at the same time!

Compro and Leadtek Winfast bundle heaps of premium video editing software such as Ulead's DVD MovieFactory and VideoStudio. Pinnacle bundles Studio QuickStart 10.

Looks And Build

The external TV-Tuners came in all shapes and sizes, and we would like to mention a few notables. The Compro VideoMate Action Pro is, with-